

Mobile App Sync Troubleshooting

Overview

The mobile app (iOS and Android) syncs data with the cloud account every 60 seconds when the app is in the foreground, and every 15 minutes in the background via push-triggered sync. All sync conflicts are resolved using last-write-wins based on server timestamp, not device timestamp, since device clocks can drift.

Common Sync Issues

Changes made on mobile do not appear on web

First check whether the device has a active network connection, since the app queues changes locally and syncs once connectivity returns. Confirm the user is signed into the same account on both mobile and web, since duplicate accounts with similar emails are a frequent cause of this complaint. If both checks pass and the issue persists for more than 15 minutes, ask for the device sync log, accessible from Settings then Account then Export Sync Log inside the app.

Duplicate entries appearing after sync

This usually happens when a user edits the same record offline on two different devices before either device reconnects. Both edits sync successfully but as separate records, since the offline edit does not yet have a server-assigned id to merge against. The fix is to manually delete the duplicate, there is currently no automatic merge for this case. This is a known limitation, not a bug, and should be explained to the customer rather than treated as an escalation by default.

App shows old data after switching networks

Switching from WiFi to cellular or vice versa can pause the persistent sync connection for up to 30 seconds while the app re-establishes its session. A simple pull to refresh on the main screen forces an immediate manual sync rather than waiting for the automatic cycle.

Sync stuck at a fixed percentage

This typically indicates a single record with corrupted or oversized data, often an attachment over the 25 megabyte mobile upload limit, blocking the rest of the sync queue from processing. Ask the customer to check Settings then Sync then Sync Queue for a record that has stayed in pending status for more than 10 minutes, and try deleting that specific item.

Escalation Criteria

Escalate to mobile engineering if sync has been stuck for more than 1 hour despite a stable network connection, or if the customer reports sync corrupting or deleting existing data rather than merely duplicating it, since data loss reports always require investigation regardless of how minor they initially

sound.